

```
x      mx, xm, *pt2;  
y      y1;  
p1     y2, y3;  
f1     fr ft;
```

`typedef` does not create different types. Rather, it only creates synonyms of the existing ones. `typedef` is also used to define data types with a long and confusing name.

Unions

The next important data type that is often used is `unions`. This data type is used to access the same memory accessed by other data types. The declaration of a union is similar to that of a structure, but in functionality both are different. A union is declared as follows:

```
union union_name {  
  
    member_type1 member_name1;  
    member_type2 member_name2;  
    member_type3 member_name3;  
    .  
    .  
} object_names;
```

Note that in an union declaration, all the elements occupy the same physical space in memory. For example consider the following union.

```
union m1 {  
    char v;  
    int y;  
    float z;  
} my;
```

Here, three elements are declared — `v`, `y` and `z`, each having a different data type. However, all of them refer to the same memo-